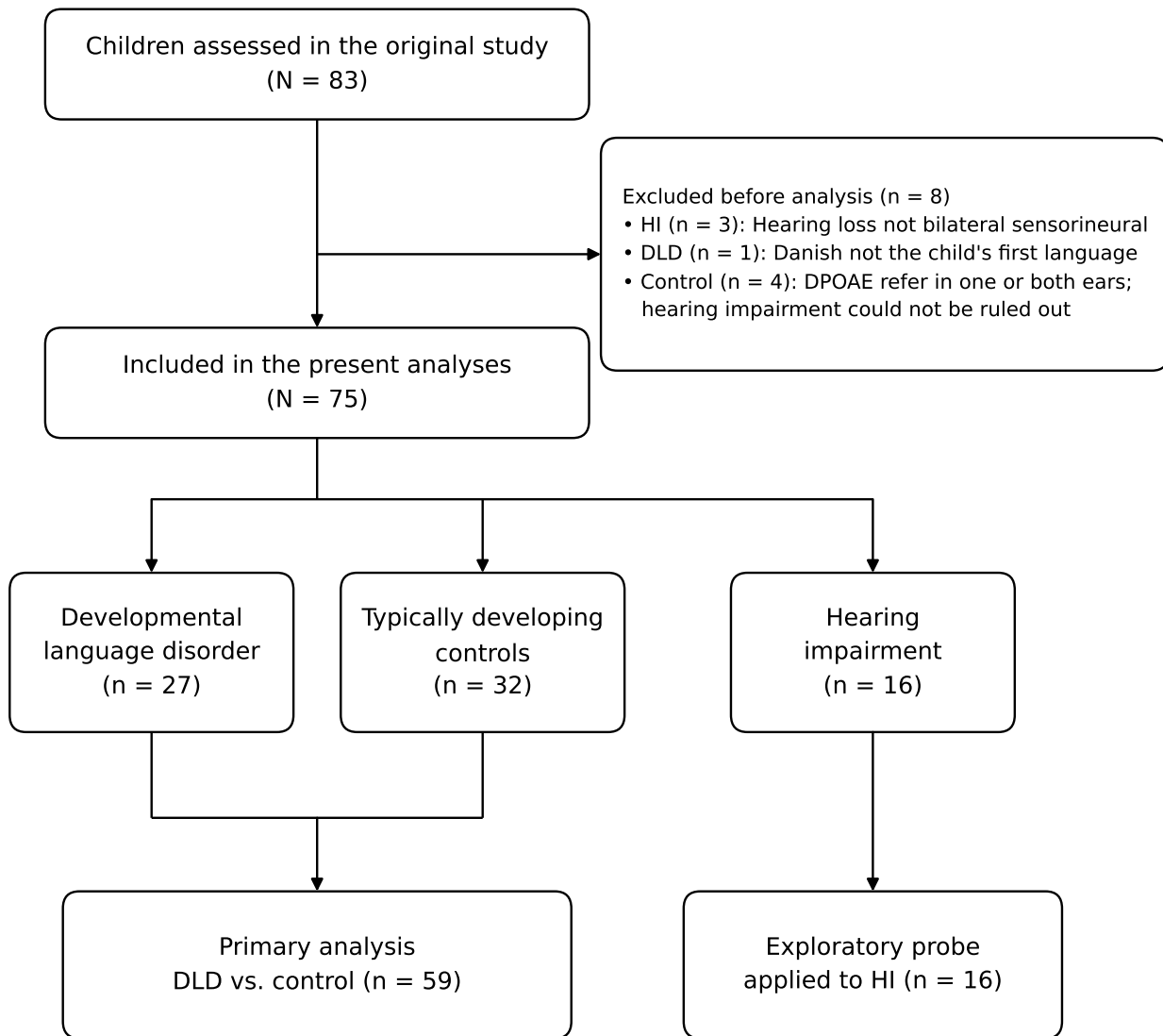




All children completed the same battery. Missing values among the retained predictors were infrequent ($\leq 8.5\%$ on any measure) and were imputed by the median fitted within each cross-validation training fold; no child was excluded for missing data. The hearing-impaired group does not enter the primary DLD-versus-control comparison.